



# WA Counter-Strike — Official Competition Rulebook

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**Effective date:** 5 October 2026

This rulebook governs participation in all Counter-Strike 2 ("CS2") competitions operated by WA Counter-Strike ("WACS", the "Tournament Organizer", or "TO"). It applies to the **WA League** and **One Day Cups**, across both **online** and **LAN** play. By registering for or participating in any WACS competition, all players, teams, coaches, and staff agree to comply with these rules.

Clauses that apply to only one environment are marked **[Online only]** or **[LAN only]**. All other clauses apply to both.

Where a rule asks you to contact WACS, do so by **opening a ticket at [wa-cs.com/support](https://wa-cs.com/support)**. Please do not DM staff members directly.

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## 1. General Overview

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### 1.1 Purpose

This rulebook exists to:

- Ensure fair competition
- Maintain competitive integrity
- Define player expectations and conduct
- Set out tournament procedures and penalties

### 1.2 Scope & Application

This rulebook covers the **WA League** and **One Day Cups** only. Other WACS competition formats, such as PUGs, are governed by their own separate rules.

Where a specific competition publishes its own supplementary rules (for example, a particular format, schedule, or prize structure), those rules apply in addition to this book. If they ever conflict, the competition-specific rules take precedence for that competition.

## 1.3 Administration

The Tournament Organizer reserves the right to:

- Modify these rules at any time
- Interpret these rules where they are unclear
- Issue rulings in circumstances not covered by this book
- Penalize participants for behaviour detrimental to the competition

Staff rulings are final, subject only to the appeals process in Section 12.3.

## 1.4 Definitions

- **TO / Tournament Organizer** — WA Counter-Strike (WACS), the operator of the competition.
- **Staff** — WACS administrators and officials authorised to run matches and issue rulings.
- **Active Duty pool** — the current competitive map pool used in official Valve and tier-one events (see Section 6.4).
- **Bo1 / Bo3 / Bo5** — Best of one, three, or five maps.
- **MR12** — “Maximum Rounds 12”; each half is 12 rounds, and the first team to 13 rounds wins the map.
- **Veto** — the process by which teams ban and pick maps before a match.
- **Match week** — the period in which a round of a competition is played. Unless a competition states otherwise, a match week runs from Monday to Sunday, Perth time (AWST).
- **Match night** — the day and time on which every match in a match week is scheduled unless the two teams agree a different time.
- **Scheduled match time** — the time a match is currently set to be played, as shown on the WACS website. All times are Perth time (AWST).
- **Knife round** — a round played with knives only to decide starting sides on a map.
- **Smurf** — an account used by a player to misrepresent their identity or skill level.
- **Walkover / Forfeit** — a match awarded to one team because the opponent did not field a valid lineup or comply with procedure.
- **LAN** — an in-person event played on-site (for example, at a LAN café).
- **Online** — a match played remotely over the internet.

# 2. Eligibility

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## 2.1 Player Requirements

All players must:

- Own a valid Steam account and use that registered account during competition

- Not be banned by Valve Anti-Cheat (VAC) or by the platforms WACS uses
- Meet the residency and age requirements below

## 2.2 Residency & Age

- Players must be **residents of Western Australia**.
- Players must be **16 years of age or older**. Players under 16 may compete only with verifiable parental or guardian consent provided to staff on request.

There is no skill or rank cap — WACS is open to all eligible players regardless of rank.

## 2.3 Team Composition

Each team may register:

- Five (5) starting players
- Up to two (2) substitute players
- One (1) coach (optional)

Only registered roster members may participate in a team's matches.

## 2.4 Roster Locks & Changes

- **Rosters lock 7 days before the first playoff match.** After lock, any roster change requires staff approval and is granted at staff discretion (for example, to allow an emergency substitution).
- **A player may move teams at most once every 14 days.** A player who joins a team, whether new to the competition or moving from another team, cannot join a different team until 14 days have passed since they joined.
- **Teams must keep a core of three (3) players.** At least three players from a team's registered starting five must remain on its roster for the whole competition.
- Unauthorised roster changes may result in map loss, match forfeit, or disqualification.

## 2.5 Account Integrity & Multiple Teams

Players may not:

- Compete for more than one team in the same competition, unless approved in advance by all affected teams and staff
- Share accounts
- Smurf or use alternate accounts

# 3. Player Conduct

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### 3.1 Sportsmanship

All participants must behave respectfully toward opponents, teammates, staff, broadcast crew, spectators, and the wider community.

Competitive trash talk is acceptable. Harassment, abuse, and threats are not.

### 3.2 Prohibited Conduct

The following are strictly prohibited:

- Harassment
- Racism, sexism, homophobia, or any other hate speech
- Threats or intimidation
- Excessive toxicity
- Match fixing
- Stream sniping
- Impersonation

### 3.3 Cheating

Cheating in any form is forbidden, including:

- Aimbots
- Wallhacks
- Radar hacks
- Trigger bots
- Scripting and macros — this includes snap-tap / SOCD-style movement features (rapid trigger is acceptable)
- Exploiting unintended game bugs
- Unauthorised third-party software

Any player found cheating may face immediate disqualification and a permanent ban from WACS competition.

### 3.4 Competitive Integrity

Teams must always genuinely attempt to win their matches. Intentionally losing, sandbagging, or otherwise manipulating results is prohibited.

### 3.5 Anti-Cheat & Prior Bans

WACS relies on **VAC** and **post-match demo review** for cheat detection.

WACS also recognises cheating bans issued elsewhere. A player who is currently banned for cheating by Valve (VAC), a recognised anti-cheat provider, or another reputable platform or tournament

organiser may be refused entry to, or removed from, WACS competition — whether or not the conduct occurred at a WACS event. Players must disclose any such ban on request. Whether a given ban applies is determined at staff discretion.

## 4. Tournament Format

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### 4.1 Match Types

Matches are played as one of:

- Best of One (Bo1)
- Best of Three (Bo3)
- Best of Five (Bo5)

The match type for each stage is announced before the competition begins.

### 4.2 Tournament Structures

A competition may use any of the following structures:

- Single Elimination
- Double Elimination
- Swiss System
- Round Robin
- Group Stage + Playoffs

The structure for each competition is announced before it begins.

### 4.3 Seeding

Seeding may be determined by ranking, previous results, or staff discretion. The seeding method is announced before the competition begins.

## 5. Match Procedures

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### 5.1 Match Scheduling

**[Online only]** Each round of a league competition is played in a match week, and each match week has a match night. WACS announces the match night before the competition begins.

- Every match is scheduled for its match week's match night as soon as its two teams are known.

- The scheduled match time is the time shown for the match on the WACS website at [wa-cs.com](http://wa-cs.com). All times are Perth time (AWST).
- A match stays at its scheduled match time unless it is rescheduled under Section 5.2 or moved by staff.
- A match whose teams are decided by an earlier match is scheduled for its own match week's match night once both teams are known. If that match night has already passed, staff set the time.

**[LAN only]** A stage played at a LAN or in a single day has no match night. Its matches are played in bracket order on the day, and each match starts when both teams and a server are ready. Staff direct the order of play.

## 5.2 Rescheduling

**[Online only]** A team that cannot play at the scheduled match time may ask its opponent to play at a different time.

1. **Who may ask and answer.** A team's captain or registered coach may send, accept, decline, or cancel a reschedule request on behalf of the team. A decision made by either is binding on the team.
2. **How.** Requests are made and answered on the match's page on the WACS website. Where the website cannot be used, a request may be made or answered by opening a support ticket, and the same deadlines apply.
3. **Where the new time may fall.** The new time must fall within the same match week. A time outside the match week requires staff approval. A team may play two matches in the same match week.
4. **Deadline.** A reschedule must be settled at least **1 hour before the scheduled match time**. After that the match time is locked and only staff can change it. A request that is not accepted by then expires, and the match is played at its scheduled time.
5. **Answering a request.** The opposing team should accept or decline as soon as it can. Declining does not need a reason, but teams are expected to act in good faith and to offer an alternative where they can.
6. **No reply.** A request that the opposing team has not answered **within 24 hours of being sent is accepted automatically**, and the match moves to the requested time. This applies only where the 24 hours end before the deadline in clause 4 and at least 24 hours before the requested time, so that a team always has a day's notice of a time it did not answer. A request sent too late for this needs a reply, and expires at the deadline if it does not get one. A new time must be more than 1 hour away when it is requested.
7. **Being reachable.** Teams are told about requests through the WACS website and by Discord message. It is each team's responsibility to keep its captain's and coach's Discord accounts linked to their WACS accounts and to check for requests. A request is not accepted automatically while nobody on the opposing team has a linked Discord account; staff decide it instead.

8. **One request at a time.** A match can have one open request. A team that would prefer a different time declines and sends its own. A match that has already been rescheduled can be rescheduled again under the same rules.
9. **Staff changes.** Staff may move any match at any time, including after the deadline, to resolve clashes, server availability, or circumstances these rules do not cover. Staff tell both teams when they do.

An accepted reschedule stands until another request is accepted or staff move the match. The match is played at the new time, and Section 5.4 applies to it.

### 5.3 Ready-Up

Matches are created on the WACS website at [wa-cs.com](http://wa-cs.com).

1. The map veto for a match opens **30 minutes before the scheduled match time**. Both teams are notified when it opens.
2. Each team's captain picks the five players for the match and readies up on the veto page. The veto begins once both captains are ready.
3. After the veto, the chosen players join the server and ready up. Only those five are added to the server, and the match goes live once all of them on each side have readied up.

### 5.4 Punctuality

Teams must be ready to play at the scheduled match time. A team is **late** if its captain has not readied up on the veto page by the scheduled match time. The following default penalties apply equally **online and at LAN**:

- **10 minutes late** — warning
- **15 minutes late** — map loss
- **20 minutes late** — match forfeit

In a Bo1, a map loss decides the match, so the 15 minute penalty is a match forfeit.

The WACS website records lateness and proposes these penalties. **A penalty takes effect only when staff confirm it**, and staff may adjust or waive it for exceptional circumstances. Time lost to a fault that is not the team's — for example, a veto that opened late or no server being available — does not count against a team. Once both captains have readied up, lateness in joining the server is judged by staff.

Teams waiting on a late opponent should stay on the veto page until staff confirm the outcome.

### 5.5 Forfeits

A team may forfeit a map or match if it fails to field a valid five-player lineup, is late under Section 5.4, abandons a match, or breaches procedure in a way these rules specify. Staff confirm all forfeits.

**[Online only]** A match that is not played within its match week is forfeited, unless staff agree there are exceptional circumstances.

## 5.6 Score Reporting

Match results are recorded automatically through the WACS match system. If a result is recorded incorrectly, captains should raise it with staff before the next round of the competition begins.

# 6. Game Settings

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## 6.1 Game Version

All matches are played on the latest live version of Counter-Strike 2 unless staff state otherwise.

## 6.2 Match Settings

Standard competitive settings apply:

- MR12 format (first to 13 rounds)
- Overtime enabled (see Section 6.3)
- Competitive damage settings
- Friendly fire enabled
- Team collision enabled

## 6.3 Overtime

If a map is tied 12–12, it is decided in overtime:

- Overtime is played **MR3** (first to 4 rounds wins the overtime).
- Each team starts overtime with **\$10,000**.
- Teams switch sides after every three rounds.
- If an overtime ends tied, a further overtime is played under the same rules until a winner is decided.

## 6.4 Map Pool

WACS uses the **current CS2 Active Duty map pool** as set by Valve, so that play matches tier-one tournaments. At the time of writing, that pool is:

- Ancient
- Anubis
- Cache
- Dust II
- Inferno
- Mirage
- Nuke

When Valve updates the Active Duty pool, WACS follows suit. The TO may make a temporary exception where necessary (for example, if a map is broken by a recent update).

## 7. Map Veto Process

Vetos are handled on the WACS website at [wa-cs.com](https://wa-cs.com). The veto opens 30 minutes before the scheduled match time, the captains from both teams ready up, and the veto begins once both are ready. Each captain has **1 minute per selection** by default. Staff may also run the veto manually and build the match accordingly.

### 7.1 Best of One (Bo1)

1. Team A bans a map.
2. Team B bans a map.
3. Teams alternate bans until one map remains, which is played.

### 7.2 Best of Three (Bo3)

1. Team A bans one map.
2. Team B bans one map.
3. Team A picks a map; Team B chooses the starting side.
4. Team B picks a map; Team A chooses the starting side.
5. Team A bans one map.
6. Team B bans one map.
7. The remaining map is the decider.

### 7.3 Best of Five (Bo5)

1. Team A bans one map.
2. Team B bans one map.
3. Team A picks a map; Team B chooses the starting side.
4. Team B picks a map; Team A chooses the starting side.
5. Team A picks a map; Team B chooses the starting side.
6. Team B picks a map; Team A chooses the starting side.
7. The remaining map is the decider.

### 7.4 Side Selection

On a picked map, the team that did not pick it chooses the starting side, as set out above. On any **decider map**, starting sides are decided by a **knife round**.

## 8. Pauses & Disconnects

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### 8.1 Tactical Pauses

Each team may take tactical pauses according to the match settings — by default, **three (3) pauses of 30 seconds** each per map.

### 8.2 Technical Pauses

Technical pauses are allowed for genuine technical problems, including server issues, hardware failure, internet instability, and game crashes. Staff may request proof of the issue.

A team may use up to **15 minutes** of technical pause time in total per match. Staff may grant extensions. If the limit is exceeded, the affected team is given the choice to continue play or forfeit the match.

### 8.3 Disconnects

If a player disconnects:

- The match continues unless a valid pause is called.
- A reasonable amount of time may be granted for the player to reconnect.
- If delays become excessive, staff may direct play to continue without the disconnected player.

## 9. Streaming & Broadcasting

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### 9.1 Official Broadcast

The TO holds exclusive broadcasting rights to WACS competitions.

### 9.2 Player Streaming

A player who wishes to stream their own point of view must first contact WACS for approval and validation of their stream settings (for example, an appropriate stream delay). This applies both online and at LAN.

### 9.3 Spectators

Spectators are welcome at WACS events.

- **[LAN only]** Spectators may stand behind players to watch. If this becomes a distraction, the affected team's captain should call a pause and ask a staff member to resolve the situation.
- **[LAN only]** Events held at LAN cafés may have other patrons present. If a nearby patron is particularly disruptive, staff will try to help by escalating to the café operator, but no guarantee can be made.

## 10. Coaching

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WACS coaching rules follow tier-one tournament practice. They apply equally online and at LAN.

### 10.1 Permitted Communication

A coach may communicate with their team during:

- Warmup
- The freeze (buy) time at the start of each round
- Tactical and technical pauses
- The breaks between maps

### 10.2 Restrictions

Coaches **must not** communicate with their team while a round is live — that is, from the moment the round goes live until it ends. Breaches may result in penalties under Section 13.

### 10.3 Scheduling

A team's registered coach may send and answer reschedule requests for the team under Section 5.2. A coach's decision binds the team in the same way as the captain's.

## 11. Technical Issues

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### 11.1 Equipment Responsibility

Players are responsible for:

- A stable internet connection [**Online only**]
- Functional peripherals
- An updated game client
- Proper account access

### 11.2 Server Problems

Where there is a server problem, staff may restart matches, restore rounds where possible, reschedule matches, or change servers.

## 12. Protests, Appeals & Disputes

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## 12.1 Filing a Protest

A protest must:

- Be submitted within the timeframe set for that competition
- Include evidence (for example, screenshots, demos, or clips)
- Be submitted respectfully
- Be lodged by **opening a ticket at [wa-cs.com/support](https://wa-cs.com/support)** — do not DM staff members directly

## 12.2 Staff Decisions

Staff rulings are final, subject only to the appeals process below.

## 12.3 Appeals

A ruling may be appealed:

- Lodge the appeal via [wa-cs.com/support](https://wa-cs.com/support) **within 72 hours** of the ruling.
- The appeal must include **new evidence** not already considered in the original ruling.
- A senior staff member **not involved in the original decision** will review the appeal.
- The outcome of the appeal is final.

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# 13. Penalties

## 13.1 Types of Penalties

Penalties may include:

- Warnings
- Round deductions
- Map forfeits
- Match forfeits
- Prize reductions
- Suspensions
- Permanent bans

## 13.2 Escalation

Repeated or severe violations may result in increased penalties. Staff decide the appropriate penalty for each situation.

## 14. Media & Content Rights

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By participating, players grant the TO permission to:

- Broadcast their matches
- Use player and team names and logos
- Record gameplay
- Publish highlights and promotional content

## 15. Rule Changes

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The Tournament Organizer reserves the right to update this rulebook, resolve situations it does not cover, and act to preserve competitive fairness. Major changes will be communicated to teams where possible.

## 16. Final Agreement

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Participation in a WACS competition constitutes full acceptance of:

- This rulebook
- Staff decisions
- Platform rules
- Applicable game publisher policies

Failure to comply may result in removal from the competition.